

Apex Systems - Proposal

Response to RFP-2026-017: Cloud Procurement Analytics Platform for Northwind Retail Group
Submission date: 2026-03-02 | Fictional document for classroom use

1. Executive Summary & Understanding of Requirement

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native procurement analytics platform built on a microservices architecture deployed across two availability zones on Azure. Our design prioritises security, scalability and deep integration with Northwind's SAP S/4HANA, Coupa and Snowflake estate.

We understand Northwind needs a single source of truth for spend, supplier performance and contract compliance across 14 business units, replacing 30+ spreadsheets and a legacy Cognos deployment.

2. Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

Architecture: event-driven ingestion using Kafka connectors, a medallion data lakehouse (bronze/silver/gold) on Delta Lake, and a GraphQL API layer. Pre-built, certified connectors for SAP S/4HANA (OData + IDoc), Coupa REST API, Workday and Snowflake secure data sharing. All integrations are bidirectional with retry queues and dead-letter handling.

Scalability: horizontally autoscaled Kubernetes (AKS) services, load tested to 50 million spend lines and 2,000 concurrent users with p95 dashboard latency under 1.8 seconds. Multi-region disaster recovery with RPO 15 minutes and RTO 2 hours.

Analytics: spend cube, supplier scorecards, contract leakage detection and a forecasting module using gradient-boosted models, with lineage visible from every dashboard tile back to source records.

3. Timeline, Team Structure & Milestones

Phase	Timing	Milestone
Discovery & architecture sign-off	Weeks 1-3	Solution design approved
Integration build (SAP, Coupa, Workday)	Weeks 4-11	Data flowing into silver layer
Analytics & dashboards	Weeks 9-15	UAT-ready dashboards
Security testing & UAT	Weeks 16-18	Pen test passed, UAT sign-off
Go-live & hypercare	Weeks 19-20	Production go-live

Team: Engagement lead, solution architect, 2 data engineers, 2 integration engineers, security engineer, BI developer, QA analyst (9 FTE at peak). Named architect: Dr. Lena Moravec (12 years data platforms).

4. Pricing

Item	Cost (USD)
Platform licence (3 years)	\$540,000
Implementation services	\$410,000
Integration connectors (4)	\$120,000
Security hardening & pen testing	\$60,000
Training & change management	\$45,000
Premium support (3 years)	\$165,000
Total	\$1,340,000

Assumptions:

- Prices exclude Azure consumption, estimated at \$6,500/month.
- Northwind provides SAP and Coupa sandbox access by week 3.
- Fixed price for listed scope; change requests billed at \$1,650/day.

5. Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certified (certificate IS-778120) and SOC 2 Type II report (Dec 2025) available under NDA.
- AES-256 encryption at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit, customer-managed keys in Azure Key Vault.
- SSO via Azure AD / SAML 2.0, role-based and row-level security by business unit.
- Immutable audit logs retained for 7 years; GDPR data processing agreement and EU data residency.
- Quarterly third-party penetration tests; critical vulnerabilities patched within 72 hours.

Risk management:

- Risk register maintained weekly with owners and mitigations.
- Key risk: delayed sandbox access - mitigated by mock data contracts from week 1.

6. Support Model, Experience & References

Support: Business-hours support (08:00-18:00 CET) with 4-hour response for P1 incidents; 24x7 available as an add-on. Named customer success manager and quarterly service reviews.

Relevant experience: Delivered 11 procurement analytics platforms since 2019, including for a European grocery chain (9,000 suppliers) and a logistics group.

References:

- Helvetia Foods AG - Head of Procurement Analytics (contact on request)
 - TransEuro Logistics - CIO office (contact on request)
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